

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Catherine grew up in a single-parent household after her mom passed away when she was young. As a little girl, Catherine idolized her dad and wanted to be just like him—a pilot. Even though women weren't commonly accepted as pilots at the time, Catherine set that goal for herself and never let it go. After college, she went to work in the airline industry but, because female pilots were unheard of, Catherine spent five years as a flight attendant while she honed her piloting skills. By age twenty-six, she started working as a pilot for a small regional airline. She continued to break down the barriers in her way and was hired to fly for a large commercial airline at age thirty. From a young age, Catherine never lost sight of her piloting dreams. She just kept hammering away at them until the world caught up to her.

Her goals weren't restricted to flying, either. As she began to earn greater income, Catherine set her sights on financial independence. She started reading books on real estate and even took a class to learn about investments. Her education turned into concrete financial goals, and she began investing regularly into mutual funds. She kept her eye on the prize over the years as she continued to advance in her career, weighing all her financial decisions against her millionaire goals. She cut back on her restaurant budget to free up more money to invest. She even stopped buying coffee when she wasn't flying because she could drink as much coffee as she wanted for free on the plane. She was committed to putting every dollar to work for her millionaire goals, because she was determined to keep the millionaire promise she had made to herself.

Today, of course, Catherine has reached her goal of financial independence with a whopping \$3.4 million net worth! With those goals met, she's already looking to the future again and setting concrete goals for what she wants her wealth to do after she's gone. Not only will she leave money to her loved ones, but she'll also leave a nice scholarship fund for students who want to learn to fly. Even when she's gone, Catherine's knack for setting and crushing goals will be a blessing to her family, friends, and a whole new generation of pilots.

Do you think Catherine believed this was possible when she was twenty-one years old and couldn't find work as a pilot? I do. I think she had a crystal-clear image of her future—even when the odds seemed stacked against her—and she had the heart and determination to make it a reality. That's what millionaires do: they set goals. They *have* to, because becoming a millionaire takes a long time for most people. Remember, real millionaires don't bother trying to get rich quick; they strive to build wealth over many